Toolkit

for Navigating Your Collaboration



Observe

Notice what's happening without jumping to conclusions.



Learn

Question my interpretation and understand the impact.



Decide

Explore my options and choose my next step consciously.



Repeat

Observe the actual effects and keep learning.

A note from Maike Sestendrup



I'm so glad you want to use this worksheet. It is designed for those collaborations that feel tricky, unclear, or simply important enough to look at more consciously.

Whenever you're facing one of these situations - pull it out. Go through the questions and see how the conversation changes.

And then... please tell me what happened.

I would genuinely love to hear how the ideas from my talk resonated with you:
Which collaboration did you try to improve with this worksheet?
Did it help? What did you notice - and which next step did you choose?

in Message me on LinkedIn ← Click me

Usage Note

The PDF is interactive - simply click or tap the purple fields to fill it in.

iPhone users: When opening the PDF in Apple Preview, double-tap a purple text field to start typing. To use the checkboxes, make sure the Fill tool in Preview is turned off.

Use this as a thinking space, not a test. Write what is true for you right now – then revisit it after you act.

OBSERVE | LEARN | DECIDE | REPEAT

Notice what's happening without jumping to conclusions.

1 What am I and others doing or not doing?

My actions / non-actions

Others' actions / non-actions

2 What am I assuming / believing?

3 What is happening around us?

4 What are the current conditions and limits?

Stay close to what you can actually observe. Separate what happened from the story you are telling yourself about it.

Question your interpretation and understand the impact.

1 What is the impact of our actions, external factors, conditions & limits?

What seems to be helping?

What seems to be getting in the way?

What impact does this have on the collaboration?

Look for impact, not blame. What patterns become visible when you consider actions, context, conditions and limits together?

Challenge the assumptions you surfaced on the previous page.

2 **How are my feelings and beliefs shaping my assumptions - and which facts support or contradict them?**



Feelings & Beliefs



Facts

Assumption	PRO	CONTRA	PRO	CONTRA

Try to challenge more than one assumption. A feeling can be important without being a fact. A fact can support or contradict the story you are currently telling yourself.

Make the trade-offs visible.

3 **How do our actions affect our collaboration, now and in the long run?**



Short-term	Long-term

You don't need to understand everything before you decide.
But you want to understand enough to make a conscious choice.

Explore your options and choose your next step consciously.

Be aware of your intuition, limits and priorities.

1 Which assumptions are worth checking (relevance, uncertainty, testability, impact of challenging)?

Assumptions I want to check

Assumptions I won't check now

2 What do we want to achieve now and in the long run?

Compare your options before choosing.

3 **What options do I have, and what are their potential benefits and costs?**

Options	Benefits	Costs

4 **Which trade-offs am I willing to make when choosing my next step?**

Possible actions

Use these as inspiration - not as a checklist you have to complete.

- [ ] Change my mindset
- [ ] Check assumptions by asking
- [ ] Make impact visible
- [ ] Give feedback and demand
- [ ] Set boundaries or escalate
- [ ] Accept the situation
- [ ] Align a shared understanding of short-term & long-term success
- [ ] Initiate discussion

YOUR RESULT

My conscious next step

The choice I want to take forward from this reflection

Observe the actual effects and keep learning.

Observe again

What impact did my actions have?

Did anything unexpected happen? Were my assumptions confirmed?

Learn again

What did I learn?

Decide if needed

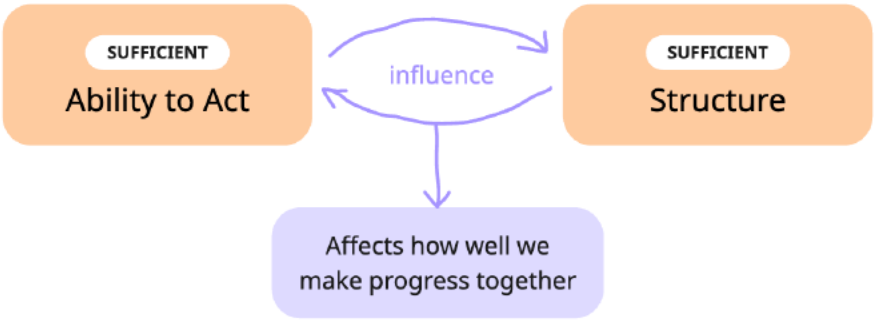
What will I keep, change, stop or try next?

Repeat

The actual effects of your action become new observations – and new material for learning.

Reminder

Conditions for Collective Action



Collaboration & Influence Loop

